

TEST4 One-on-One Q&A

Area	Question	Answer
Capabilities	Does WSTF have multifunction calibrators?	Yes. A full list of IAGP, including calibration lab equipment, will be provided as a future RFP attachment. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Capabilities	Does WSTF handle other surge type operations or does it know customer needs pretty far out?	NASA WSTF consistently performs surge type operations, (unpredictable test requests by customers, expedited requests, responding to breaking or failed equipment). Some customer needs are known well in advance and can be scheduled appropriately. Other predictable workloads include calibration and maintenance activities.
Capabilities	Do you find customers request design of test specific items to be able to test articles?	Historically, WSTF works very closely with customers to perform any test requested. Many times this testing involves the design, build and use of test specific items.
Capabilities	Is technical design services something WSTF is interested in?	NASA WSTF reserves the right to use resources other than the TEST contract. Technical design service requirements, if any, will be described in the RFP.
Capabilities	Is the ability to collaborate on testing and perform testing via uniquely designed objects a value add to WSTF?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Capabilities	Does WSTF need the capability to go above 500 pounds of TNT energy?	Required capabilities will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Capabilities	Is WSTF getting into nuclear space propulsion?	WSTF does not have any plans to get into nuclear space technology testing or evaluation. Should WSTF choose to add nuclear space propulsion capabilities, the change will be reflected in the RFP.
Capabilities	Is the plan for fire and protective services to be a part of the TEST4 contract?	It is currently NASA's intention to retain those services under the TEST4 contract. However, the acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase and NASA's determination will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
CBA	Does the machine shop fall under IAMAW?	IAMAW covers all technicians, including the machine shop.
CBA	What percentage of labor is CBA based?	Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
CBA	Does the CBA mostly cover technicians?	Yes, the IAMAW CBA covers technicians and other service personnel. The IAFF CBA covers the WSTF Firefighters Association. Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
CBA	Will the CBAs be published?	Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Challenges	What are some of the major challenges going into TEST4?	The offeror is responsible for identifying and mitigating major challenges at time of proposal.
Challenges	Is there anything besides retention of skillsets that WSTF foresees as being a major issue?	The offeror is responsible for identifying and mitigating major issues at time of proposal.
Challenges	What are the biggest challenges being faced on the current contract?	The offeror is responsible for identifying and mitigating major challenges at time of proposal.
Challenges	What are the top 3 risks WSTF faces today?	The offeror is responsible for identifying and mitigating risks to successful contract performance at time of proposal.
Challenges	What are the primary concerns/constraints with contract transition?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. The final RFP will define the required phase-in plan elements, if applicable. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Clearance	What is the typical length of time to hire someone with a clearance and who is it done through?	NASA does not currently possess that information. However, clearances will be processed in accordance with the Defense Security Service Industrial Personnel Security Clearance Process located at https://www.dcsa.mil .
Contract Type	Is TEST4 going to be a CPAF contract?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase and the final contract type is still being determined. The final RFP will define the contract type.
Contract Type	Will the contract be cost plus?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase and the final contract type is still being determined. The final RFP will define the contract type. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Contract Type	Are there any thoughts about increasing the FFP portions of the TEST contract?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase and the final contract type is still being determined. The final RFP will define the contract type. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Equipment	Will TEST4 be responsible for fixing breaks or repairing in advanced equipment?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. The party responsible for performing repairs will be determined in accordance with the terms of the TEST4 contract.
Equipment	Is the equipment shown as part of the site tour GFP or does the Government own it?	The Government owns the equipment and it is provided as IAGP instead of GFP.
Equipment	Is the TEST contractor responsible for acquiring spare parts for equipment?	Yes, the contractor is responsible for purchasing these materials.
Equipment	From the contract perspective, is the IAGP equipment the only equipment requiring maintenance and repairs?	Maintenance and repairs will be required to be performed on IAGP and other Government property.
Exchanges With Industry	Are there potential opportunities for additional one on one meetings with the TEST4 board?	One on one meetings are subject to acquisition team availability but offerors may email the TEST4 inbox to schedule meetings. Best efforts will be made to accommodate all meeting requests. Virtual meetings are preferred
Exchanges With Industry	Are there plans to create further opportunities for industry to engage with the acquisition team?	One on one meetings are subject to acquisition team availability but offerors may email the TEST4 inbox to schedule meetings. Best efforts will be made to accommodate all meeting requests. Virtual meetings are preferred. Additional questions and information for NASA's consideration may also be submitted to the TEST4 inbox.

Exchanges With Industry	Where can further questions be submitted?	Additional questions may be submitted to the TEST4 inbox
Exchanges With Industry	What technical POCs are available for industry to reach out to and what technical information can be provided?	The first part of the technical library has already been posted to SAM.gov via the RFI notice. To communicate with technical POCs, continue to email the TEST4 inbox.
Exchanges With Industry	Are one on one meetings able to be scheduled with the acquisition team?	One on one meetings are subject to acquisition team availability but offerors may email the TEST4 inbox to schedule meetings. Best efforts will be made to accommodate all meeting requests. Virtual meetings are preferred
Exchanges With Industry	Is WSTF willing to accept offeror provided information and suggestions based on other Government contracts?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Information for NASA's consideration may be submitted to the TEST4 inbox.
External Customers	Has WSTF seen a steady rate of Space Act Agreement work or what's the trend?	WSTF has experienced some increase in reimbursable work.
Fixed Fee	Did TEST3 ever transition from award fee to fixed fee?	No, it did not.
Future Work	What do the next five years look like with what WSTF is worried and excited about? How is technology changing the outlook?	NASA is unable to share any information about future work beyond what is publicly available.
Future Work	How does WSTF's forward demand look?	NASA is unable to share any information about future work beyond what is publicly available.
Future Work	Is there a need for a business development activity to continue to sell the site and find additional work?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Future Work	Can WSTF provide details about future work?	No, the acquisition team cannot provide anything beyond what's already been made public.
Future Work	Will there incentives for the contractor to bring in commercial work?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. The final RFP will reflect any incentives. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Future Work	What is WSTF's appetite for offerors finding way to find ways of utilizing excess workload capacity?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Geography	Is there value to WSTF for the contractor to be close to JSC/ in the Houston area or is the TEST contract geographically agnostic?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Mission	What mission outcomes matter most in the first 12-24 months of the contract?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Particular areas of emphasis will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Mission	What will the emphasis of the first 30/60/90/180 days be?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Particular areas of emphasis will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Mission	What are the top 3 obstacles to mission delivery?	The offeror is responsible for identifying and mitigating obstacles to mission delivery at time of proposal.
NAICS	Is NASA still intending to stay under the 541715 NAICS?	The anticipated NAICS code for this acquisition is 541715, Exception 3. The final NAICS code will be reflected in the RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
OCI	How does NASA envision OCI mitigation if a conflict involving something such as components is provided to a customer performing testing at WSTF?	OCI will be handled in accordance with all applicable OCI clauses, policies, and procedures contained in the final RFP.
OCI	Will there be an OCI clause in the TEST4 contract?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Applicable sections of the FAR will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Period of Performance	Has the acquisition team looked at a longer period of performance?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. The period of performance will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Personnel	Will potential site personnel reorganization impact performance of the TEST4 contract?	NASA does not currently possess information regarding anticipated impacts to the TEST4 contract due to personnel reorganizations.
POCs	Are there any technical POCs identified for further discussions?	Additional questions may be submitted to the TEST4 inbox.
Retention	What kind of turnover does WSTF see in its technicians?	WSTF has experienced contractor personnel turnover. Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Retention	Is WSTF anticipating any more layoffs?	NASA does not currently possess information regarding the likelihood of future layoffs.
Retention	Is the contractor workforce stable?	Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Retention	Can WSTF provide historical staffing levels?	Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Retention	What are some causes of the retention issue?	The offeror is responsible for identifying and mitigating obstacles to retention delivery at time of proposal.

RFP	How will the prime offerors be determined?	Each offeror is responsible for stating if they are a prime or a subcontractor at time of proposal.
RFP	Will FAR 19 be a part of the TEST4 contract?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Applicable sections of the FAR will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	How do you perceive JVs?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	Will the RFP riddle be similar to the TEST3 one?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	How are the changes in administration affecting WSTF and is there anything that's different in this procurement compared to the previous ones?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Any applicabe updates due to regulatory changes will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	Is the L&M language anticipated to have significant updates from the TEST3 RFP/is there going to be an emphasis on innovation and efficiencies?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	Do hypergols procurements fall under the TEST contract?	The RFP will contain the complete list, but liquid oxygen and liquid nitrogen are funded through separate contract vehicles. The TEST contractor is responsible for procurement of hypergols beyond what is procured under the agencywide contract.
RFP	Is there a requirement for a sub to be listed as a major sub if the prime is submitting their past performance?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. This type of information will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	What will the key personnel section of the RFP look like?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. This type of information will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	Is there a move to make TEST4 a completely FFP contract?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase and the final contract type is still being determined. The final RFP will define the contract type. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	Is the 60 day phase-in consistent with previous version of the contract?	Yes, the 60 day phase-in period is consistent with the TEST2 and TEST3 contracts. Further information regarding the Phase-In period will be contained in the RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	What is the plan for the acquisition strategy?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	What are the evaluation factors?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	What would separate the top two bidders from the rest as far as technical vs innovation?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	How, if at all, will TEST4 and its evaluation by changes in agency goals, specifically regarding innovations?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. The TEST4 final RFP will be reflective of the most current guidance and goals concerning innovations.
RFP	What can the TEST4 contractor do to maximize use of WSTF facilities?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	What impacts will the Revolutionary Far Overhaul and class deviations have to the RFP?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. The applicability of the RFO is currently unknown, but will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
RFP	Is WSTF looking at innovative ideas to increase efficiencies in both systems and personnel?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Evaluation factors will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Safety	Does WSTF track time lost to injuries?	Yes, WSTF tracks time lost to injuries for various purposes such as OSHA reporting and internal trend analysis. Requirements related to workplace injury tracking will be made available as future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Schedule	What's next given the agile procurement process?	The TEST4 website provides an updated schedule. Continue to monitor the TEST4 website and SAM.gov.
Schedule	Is the anticipated draft RFP release date of March still accurate?	Yes, that timeframe is still accurate. The TEST4 website provides an updated schedule. Continue to monitor the TEST4 website and SAM.gov for any updates to the schedule.
Site Tour	Can you share the site visit attendee contact information?	The site visit attendee list will be made available via SAM.gov.
Site Tour	Will the list of industry day attendees be published?	The site visit attendee list will be made available via SAM.gov.
Site Tour	Can the site tour script be provided?	Yes, the written talking points can be provided upon request. However, there is no script covering the entirety of the tour.
Site Workload	How much work is WSTF getting with the changes in agency emphasis?	There have been limited changes to the demand for WSTF services. Should any changes be made to WSTF capabilities, the change will be reflected in the RFP.
Skill Mix	What's the split of technicians versus employees with bachelor's/master's degrees?	NASA does not currently possess that information. Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Skill Mix	What percentage of the workforce is technicians compared to engineers?	Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.

Skill Mix	Is the Government going to provide the skill mix or will industry be expected to come up with a skill mix on its own?	Offerors will be responsible for proposing a skill mix, in accordance with the final RFP. Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Skill Mix	Is there a reason the technicians aren't broken out on a separate contract?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. The final RFP will reflect NASA's determination on the most efficient use of contractor resources. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Skill Mix	How many people are on the management side compared to engineering and technical?	That information is not currently available. Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Skill Mix	Are there requirements for manning or having personnel in the emergency dispatch?	Yes, the TEST contractor will be responsible for operating the emergency dispatch center per requirements of the RFP.
Small Business	With this being full and open competition, what will the small business subcontracting goals be?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Small business subcontracting goals, if applicable, will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Small Business	Is TEST4 being a small business set aside still on the table?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. The final type of competition will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Small Business	What was meant by asking offerors for percentages of each PWS could be performed by SB without knowing how many employees supported each section?	The question was intended for use as market research and did not require a response.
Small Business	Will the small business goals be at or near the 30% from the previous RFP?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Small business subcontracting goals, if applicable, will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Small Business	Have the small business goals been established yet?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Small business subcontracting goals, if applicable, will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Software	Has WSTF upgraded its MetCal software?	WSTF has upgraded to and currently uses Met/Team® version 3.3.1.56.
Systems	Is the expectation the contractor brings their own MES systems?	The RFP will contain information about which systems the contractor will be required to use or provide.
Systems	How much systems information will offerors get?	If the system is not mentioned in the RFP as being used or provided by the agency, the contractor will be expected to provide it.
Task Orders	Has WSTF considered having a JSC task order for calibration work?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Potential use of task orders for this purpose will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Task Orders	Can you give indications on what is FFP compared to cost reimbursable?	The RFP will state which PWS sections are intended to be issued on FFP task orders. However, the Government reserves the right to issue either as CR or FFP task orders at any time, for any subset of the work, during the contract's period of performance. There is no baseline.
Task Orders	Are specific task orders being developed for every test being performed?	Historically, most of the IDIQ task orders were developed on a customer or project basis. However, the acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase and NASA's approach to task orders will be reflected in the final RFP. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Task Orders	Will there be sample task orders?	The acquisition is still in the strategic planning phase. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.
Technical Library	Does a request need to be submitted to access the technical library?	Yes, to access the technical library, a request must be submitted. Instructions for accessing the TEST4 technical library are available on the original RFI posting.
VPP	Is VPP new to site or are the issues with VPP certification associated with incumbent issues?	No. VPP is not considered new for WSTF. WSTF pursued VPP certification as part of building a strong safety culture. NASA cannot speak to certification issues, if any.
Workload History	Will the workload history be provided?	That information is not currently available. Information of this type will be provided in future RFP attachments. Continue to monitor SAM.gov.